

COMPANION DIGITAL PACKAGE

Full Certifications Guide

Every identity and security certification worth knowing

25 certifications across 6 categories with exam details, costs, and employer value Planning guide: which cert to pursue and when

Mastering Identity Security for CIDPro™
Abbas Kudrati | 2026 Edition

25
Certifications

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Categories

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Identity-Specific

Top
Vendor-Neutral First

Appendix C

Vendor & Industry Certifications in the Identity Domain

A guide to certifications offered by leading identity vendors, professional bodies, and cloud platforms — with official URLs, costs, formats, and CIDPro book mappings

Mastering Identity Security for CIDPro • Abbas Kudrati • 2025–2026 Edition

Introduction

Identity and access management spans a remarkable spectrum of professional certifications — from comprehensive vendor-neutral credentials testing conceptual and regulatory depth, to hands-on platform certifications validating specific product skills, to highly specialised credentials covering non-human identities, cloud IAM, and AI agent governance.

This appendix catalogues every major certification relevant to IAM professionals as of 2025–2026, organised into six sections: (A) Vendor-Neutral and Professional Body; (B) Identity Governance and Administration; (C) Privileged Access Management; (D) Workforce IAM Platforms; (E) Cloud Platform Identity; and (F) Broad Cybersecurity. For each certification you will find: name, issuing body, career level, exam format, approximate cost, validity and renewal, official URL, and mapping to this book's chapters.

How to Approach Vendor Certifications Alongside CIDPro

CIDPro: Your Conceptual Foundation

CIDPro is vendor-neutral — it tests your understanding of identity concepts, protocols, governance frameworks, compliance obligations, and operational principles regardless of which tools your organisation uses. This is what makes it universally recognised by employers: a CIDPro-certified professional can step into any organisation running any identity platform and have the conceptual framework to understand what is happening and why. CIDPro increasingly appears in senior IAM job descriptions as a preferred or required qualification — it signals career seriousness in a way that a single vendor certification cannot.

Vendor Certifications: Your Operational Proof

Vendor certifications prove you can operate a specific platform. An employer hiring for a SailPoint implementation or CyberArk PAM deployment needs to know you have hands-on capability with that tool. Vendor certifications provide that evidence — they are the practical complement to CIDPro's conceptual depth.

Recommended Sequence

- Start with CIDPro (or study simultaneously): Build conceptual depth first. Understanding authentication protocols, access governance, and Zero Trust at a foundational level makes vendor training faster and more meaningful.

- Add your primary platform certification: Choose the cert for the platform your organisation uses or that dominates your target job market. Microsoft (SC-300) for Entra/Azure environments; SailPoint or Saviynt for IGA; CyberArk for PAM.
- Specialise as your role evolves: NHI Foundation if NHI governance is part of your portfolio; CISM if you move into security management; CISSP for senior security leadership; cloud certifications for cloud-first environments.
- Renew proactively: Most certifications have 2–3 year validity. Build renewal into your annual development plan.

Most Valued Certifications by Employers — Asia-Pacific and Global

Employer certification preferences differ by geography, industry, and organisation size. The following is based on analysis of IAM job postings across Asia-Pacific and global markets as of 2025.

Certification	Why Employers Value It	Most Valued In	Book Chapters
CIDPro™	Vendor-neutral, covers all IAM domains, IDPro Body of Knowledge aligned	Global — FSI, government, consulting	All chapters
SC-300 (Microsoft)	Most deployed identity platform globally (Entra ID); hands-on Entra skills in high demand	Global — especially APAC where Microsoft dominates	Ch 3, 4, 9, 10, 19, 20
CyberArk (Defender/Sentry)	PAM is #1 enterprise security priority; CyberArk is the market leader	Global; strong in BFSI, healthcare, government	Ch 19 (entire)
Okta Professional / Admin	Enterprise WIC market leader; hands-on config exam is a trusted quality signal	Global; tech, fintech, SaaS-heavy organisations	Ch 3, 5, 6–8, 9, 14
SailPoint IIQ / IdentityNow	IGA Gartner MQ Leader; enterprise demand for SailPoint skills consistently high	Global; large enterprise and FSI	Ch 6–8, 13, 19
NHI Foundation (NHIMG)	First accredited NHI credential; NHI security is the fastest-growing IAM skills gap	Global; security-mature organisations	Ch 12, 19, 20, 22
CISSP	Executive security credential; proves breadth for senior roles	Global; government, defence, FSI senior roles	All security domains
CISM (ISACA)	Management credential valued by boards and audit committees	Global; APAC government, FSI, healthcare	Ch 15–16, 22
Saviynt ISAA (FREE)	Free entry-level cert; excellent signal of foundational commitment	Global; graduates and career-changers	Ch 6–8, 13

Tips for Getting Employer-Funded Certification

1. Link to Business Value, Not Personal Development

Frame every request in terms of the problem it solves for the business: 'SC-300 will enable me to implement Conditional Access policies that reduce our identity incident volume' is more compelling than 'I want to get Microsoft certified'.

2. Bundle Multiple Certifications into One Business Case

If you need CIDPro and SC-300, present them together as a certification programme with total annual cost and combined rationale. This demonstrates strategic planning and is often easier to approve.

3. Use Vendor Benefit Programmes

- Microsoft: Free learning paths on Microsoft Learn; exam vouchers via Azure Pass programmes
- Okta: Discount campaigns for certification exams; partner benefit vouchers
- CyberArk: Training often funded as part of customer implementation projects — ask your account team
- SailPoint: Partners receive training credits; some customer agreements include Identity University access
- AWS: Training Credits available to many AWS customers and partners
- Google Cloud: Google Cloud Skills Boost provides free learning paths for partner organisations
- ISACA / (ISC)²: Corporate membership programmes provide significant exam voucher discounts

4. Commit to a 90-Day Return on Investment

Propose what you will accomplish within 90 days of earning the certification. This turns the training request into a performance commitment — and managers approve commitments more readily than open-ended development requests.

5. Start Free to Demonstrate Commitment

The Saviynt ISAA (free) and SC-900 (\$99) are low-cost proof points. Passing and presenting the result to your manager is a strong signal that a larger investment in CIDPro or a vendor certification will be completed, not abandoned.

Certification Reference Cards

A. Vendor-Neutral & Professional Body Certifications

These certifications are issued by professional bodies and independent organisations. They test conceptual depth, regulatory knowledge, and professional practice — not specific product skills. They are the most universally recognised credentials in the IAM profession.

IDPro — CIDPro™ | ♦ Vendor-Neutral

Focus: Identity & Access Management — comprehensive vendor-neutral professional certification

Field	Details
Certification(s)	Certified Identity Deployment Professional (CIDPro™)
Level	Professional (experienced practitioners)
Format	Proctored online · Multiple choice · 100 questions · 2 hours
Approximate Cost	USD \$400 (members) / \$550 (non-members)
Validity / Renewal	3 years · Renewal via CPE or re-exam
CIDPro Book Connection	This entire book is dedicated to CIDPro preparation. All 22 chapters and 330 Q&A map directly to the five CIDPro exam objectives.
Notes	The primary exam this book prepares you for. Highest-value vendor-neutral IAM credential. Appears as a preferred or required qualification in senior IAM job descriptions globally.

Official URL: <https://idpro.org/cidpro/>

Identity Management Institute — CIAM® | ♦ Vendor-Neutral

Focus: IAM programme design, implementation, and management

Field	Details
Certification(s)	Certified Identity and Access Manager (CIAM®)
Level	Expert (5+ years IAM experience recommended)
Format	Online proctored exam · Study guide included · IMI membership required
Approximate Cost	USD \$295–\$395
Validity / Renewal	Annual renewal via CPE credits
CIDPro Book Connection	Chapters 1–22 (all objectives). Strong curriculum overlap with CIDPro.
Notes	First globally registered vendor-neutral IAM credential. Widely recognised in financial services, government, and healthcare across North America and Asia-Pacific.

Official URL: <https://identitymanagementinstitute.org/ciam-certification/>

Identity Management Institute — CAMS® | ♦ Vendor-Neutral

Focus: Access management, access request processing, access reviews

Field	Details
Certification(s)	Certified Access Management Specialist (CAMS®)

Field	Details
Level	Practitioner
Format	Online proctored exam
Approximate Cost	USD \$195–\$295
Validity / Renewal	Annual renewal
CIDPro Book Connection	Ch 4 (Authorisation), Ch 6–8 (Lifecycle), Ch 13 (IGA), Ch 19 (PAM)
Notes	Specifically focused on access request workflows, provisioning, deprovisioning, and access review operations. Ideal for IGA and operations professionals.

Official URL: <https://identitymanagementinstitute.org/certification/>

Identity Management Institute — CIGE® | ♦ Vendor-Neutral

Focus: Identity governance strategy, policy development, thought leadership

Field	Details
Certification(s)	Certified Identity Governance Expert (CIGE®)
Level	Expert / Thought Leader
Format	Exam waiver available for qualifying senior practitioners
Approximate Cost	USD \$395
Validity / Renewal	Annual renewal
CIDPro Book Connection	Ch 13 (IGA), Ch 15–16 (Compliance), Ch 22 (Identity at Scale)
Notes	Distinguished credential for IAM leaders who develop new governance frameworks and standards. Recognised by regulators and senior executives. Exam waiver available.

Official URL: <https://identitymanagementinstitute.org/certification/>

Identity Management Institute — CIMP® | ♦ Vendor-Neutral

Focus: Technical IAM project implementation and system management

Field	Details
Certification(s)	Certified Identity Management Professional (CIMP®)
Level	Technical Practitioner
Format	Online proctored exam
Approximate Cost	USD \$195–\$295
Validity / Renewal	Annual renewal
CIDPro Book Connection	Ch 1–8 (Foundations & Lifecycle), Ch 9–14 (Security), Ch 17 (Standards)
Notes	Designed for IAM engineers, solution architects, and project managers who implement IAM systems. Strong market recognition in North America.

Official URL: <https://identitymanagementinstitute.org/cimp/>

Identity Management Institute — CIST® / CIPA® / CDP® | ♦ *Vendor-Neutral**Focus: Identity security technology, identity protection advisory, and data protection*

Field	Details
Certification(s)	Certified Identity and Security Technologist (CIST®) • Certified Identity Protection Advisor (CIPA®) • Certified Red Flag Specialist (CRFS®) • Certified in Data Protection (CDP®)
Level	Senior Technical → Practitioner (varies by cert)
Format	Online exam (CIST exam waiver available)
Approximate Cost	USD \$195–\$395
Validity / Renewal	Annual renewal
CIDPro Book Connection	Ch 9–14 (Security), Ch 19 (PAM), Ch 21 (Privacy), Ch 15–16 (Compliance)
Notes	CIST: technical leadership for IAM system architects. CIPA/CRFS: identity fraud and identity theft advisory. CDP: data protection compliance. IMI offers 8 total credentials covering the full breadth of the identity profession.

Official URL: <https://identitymanagementinstitute.org/certification/>**NHI Management Group — NHI Foundation Level** | ♦ *Vendor-Neutral**Focus: Non-Human Identity security — service accounts, API keys, tokens, AI agents*

Field	Details
Certification(s)	NHI Foundation Level Certification (8 CPD Hours)
Level	Foundation (open to all — beginners through experienced practitioners)
Format	Self-paced online • 5–6 hours • Instructor-led module videos • Module quizzes + final exam
Approximate Cost	Visit nhimg.org/nhi-training for current pricing
Validity / Renewal	CPD Certified • 8 CPD hours • Certificate signed by Lalit Choda (Mr. NHI), NHIMG Founder
CIDPro Book Connection	Ch 12 (Non-Human Identities), Ch 19 (Secrets Management), Ch 20 (AI Agent Monitoring), Ch 22 (Identity at Scale)
Notes	The ONLY accredited NHI-specific training and certification in the industry as of 2025. New Agentic AI module added 2025. Delivered by Lalit Choda — the #1 global voice on NHI security. Covers: NHI types and risks, lifecycle management, secrets hygiene, AI agent intersection, real-world breach case studies. 5-star rated by industry practitioners. Highly recommended for any IAM professional as NHI is now the #1 identity attack vector.

Official URL: <https://nhimg.org/nhi-training>**B. Identity Governance & Administration (IGA)**

IGA certifications validate your ability to govern identity lifecycle, run access certifications, and manage entitlements at scale — most in-demand in enterprise financial services and regulated industries.

SailPoint | ♦ IGA*Focus: Identity Governance & Administration — IdentityNow (cloud SaaS) and IdentityIQ (on-premises/hybrid)*

Field	Details
Certification(s)	SailPoint Certified IdentityNow Professional • SailPoint Certified IdentityNow Engineer • SailPoint Certified IdentityIQ Associate • SailPoint Certified IdentityIQ Professional • SailPoint Certified IdentityIQ Engineer • SailPoint Certified IdentityIQ Architect
Level	Associate → Professional → Engineer → Architect
Format	Proctored online (Examity) · 60–120 min · Multiple choice and scenario-based
Approximate Cost	Training-based credentials: USD \$150–\$200 · Role-based Professional certs: USD \$400–\$500
Validity / Renewal	3 years · Renewal exam required
CIDPro Book Connection	Ch 6–8 (Identity Lifecycle), Ch 13 (IGA), Ch 19 (PAM for entitlements), Ch 22 (Identity at Scale)
Notes	Two cert tracks: training-based (lower barrier, credential-level) and role-based (experience-required, proctored, higher credibility). IdentityNow is SailPoint's SaaS/cloud platform; IdentityIQ is the enterprise on-premises platform most used by large organisations globally. SailPoint is a Gartner MQ IGA Leader.

Official URL: <https://community.sailpoint.com/t5/SailPoint-Certifications/ct-p/product-certification-program>

Saviynt | ♦ IGA*Focus: Cloud-native IGA, Cloud PAM, application access governance, and AI-driven identity security*

Field	Details
Certification(s)	Identity Security for the AI Age (ISAA) — FREE entry-level • Saviynt Certified Professional
Level	Foundation (ISAA — free, for graduates and career-changers) → Practitioner (Certified Professional)
Format	ISAA: Online self-paced (free) · Certified Professional: Online proctored exam
Approximate Cost	ISAA: FREE (launched March 2025) · Certified Professional: see saviynt.com/university
Validity / Renewal	2 years · Renewal exam
CIDPro Book Connection	Ch 6–8 (Identity Lifecycle), Ch 13 (IGA), Ch 15–16 (Compliance)
Notes	ISAA is a breakthrough free certification launched March 2025, designed to close the global cybersecurity skills gap. Includes an AI/ML in identity security module — the first vendor certification to explicitly cover AI-era identity governance. Strongly recommended as an entry point for graduates and career-changers. The Certified Professional cert is the practitioner-level credential for hands-on Saviynt platform work.

Official URL: <https://saviynt.com/university>

C. Privileged Access Management (PAM)

PAM certifications validate your ability to secure, manage, and audit privileged access. PAM consistently ranks as the #1 enterprise security spending priority.

CyberArk | ♦ PAM

Focus: Privileged Access Management — Core PAS, EPM (Endpoint), and Identity Security (formerly Idaptive)

Field	Details
Certification(s)	CyberArk Trustee (Foundation) • CyberArk Defender PAM – PAM-DEF (Operations) • CyberArk Sentry PAM – PAM-SEN (Deployment & Configuration) • CyberArk Guardian PAM (Architecture — requires Defender + Sentry) • CyberArk Defender – EPM (Endpoint Privilege Manager) • CyberArk Defender – Identity (SSO, MFA, directory integration) • CyberArk CDE (Certified Delivery Engineer — Partners only)
Level	Foundation (Trustee) → Operations (Defender) → Deployment (Sentry) → Architecture (Guardian)
Format	⚠ From November 2025: In-person only at Pearson VUE test centres • ~65–90 questions • 90 minutes
Approximate Cost	USD ~\$200 per exam (Trustee lower; Guardian requires prerequisites)
Validity / Renewal	24 months • Re-certification exam required
CIDPro Book Connection	Ch 19 (PAM Operations — the entire chapter is dedicated to PAM), Ch 9 (Zero Trust), Ch 20 (Identity Monitoring)
Notes	CRITICAL UPDATE: As of November 1, 2025, all CyberArk exams are administered exclusively at Pearson VUE in-person test centres. Online proctored delivery is no longer available. Candidates in regions with limited Pearson VUE coverage should plan accordingly. CyberArk is a Gartner MQ PAM Leader and the Defender certification is one of the most recognised PAM credentials in enterprise security.

Official URL: <https://www.cyberark.com/services-support/certification/>

BeyondTrust | ♦ PAM

Focus: Privileged Remote Access, Password Safe, and Endpoint Privilege Management

Field	Details
Certification(s)	BeyondTrust Certified Administrator
Level	Practitioner
Format	Online exam
Approximate Cost	See BeyondTrust training portal
Validity / Renewal	2 years
CIDPro Book Connection	Ch 19 (PAM Operations), Ch 12 (NHI for service accounts)
Notes	BeyondTrust is a Gartner MQ PAM Leader. Strong market presence in financial services, healthcare, and US government. The Certified Administrator validates ability to administer BeyondTrust Privileged Remote Access and Password Safe.

Official URL: <https://www.beyondtrust.com/resources/education>

Delinea (formerly Thycotic/Centrify) | ♦ PAM*Focus: Secret Server (password vaulting), Privilege Manager (endpoint), and Cloud Suite*

Field	Details
Certification(s)	Delinea Certified PAM Professional
Level	Practitioner
Format	Online exam
Approximate Cost	See Delinea training portal
Validity / Renewal	2 years
CIDPro Book Connection	Ch 19 (PAM Operations)
Notes	Delinea was formed from the Thycotic-Centrify merger (2021) and rebranded in 2022. Strong mid-market and SME PAM presence globally. Secret Server is among the most widely deployed password vaulting solutions for mid-size enterprises.

Official URL: <https://delinea.com/resources/certification>**D. Workforce Identity & Access Management Platforms**

Workforce IAM platform certifications validate hands-on capability with the specific identity platforms used by enterprise organisations for employee, partner, and customer identity.

Okta | ♦ Workforce IAM*Focus: Workforce Identity Cloud (WIC) — SSO, MFA, Lifecycle · Customer Identity Cloud (CIC/Auth0) — CIAM*

Field	Details
Certification(s)	Okta Certified Professional • Okta Certified Administrator (Hands-On Config) • Okta Certified Consultant (Hands-On Config) • Okta Certified Developer — Workforce Identity Cloud • Okta Certified Developer — Customer Identity Cloud (Auth0) • Okta Certified Technical Architect (Board defence — all prior certs required) • Okta Certified Workflows Specialty • Okta Certified Access Gateway Specialty • Auth0 Certified Developer
Level	Foundation (Professional) → Practitioner (Admin) → Specialist (Consultant/Developer) → Expert (Technical Architect)
Format	Online proctored via ProctorU (Meazure Learning) · Hands-on configuration lab exams
Approximate Cost	USD \$250 per exam (Professional/Admin/Consultant/Developer) · \$100 retake · Technical Architect USD \$5,000 (board defence, quarterly window)
Validity / Renewal	2 years (3 years if Technical Architect earned) · Low-friction maintenance exams for renewal
CIDPro Book Connection	Ch 3 (Authentication), Ch 5 (Federation/SSO), Ch 6–8 (Identity Lifecycle), Ch 9 (Zero Trust), Ch 14 (CIAM — Auth0/CIC path)
Notes	Okta certifications are hands-on configuration exams — candidates must configure a real Okta tenant, not just answer multiple-choice questions. Professional + Administrator are the most in-demand. Technical Architect

Field	Details
	(\$5,000) is one of the most exclusive and rigorous identity architecture credentials available. Okta is a Gartner MQ IAM Leader.

Official URL: <https://www.okta.com/services/certification/>

Microsoft | ♦ Workforce IAM

Focus: Microsoft Entra ID — Identity Administration, Azure Security, Cloud Security Fundamentals

Field	Details
Certification(s)	SC-900: Security, Compliance & Identity Fundamentals • SC-300: Identity and Access Administrator Associate • AZ-500: Azure Security Engineer Associate (includes Entra IAM) • SC-200: Security Operations Analyst Associate (includes Entra Monitoring) • AZ-900: Azure Fundamentals (IAM overview)
Level	Fundamentals (SC-900, AZ-900) → Associate (SC-300, AZ-500, SC-200)
Format	Online proctored (Pearson VUE) • 40–60 questions • 45–120 minutes • Free study resources on Microsoft Learn
Approximate Cost	SC-900 / AZ-900: USD \$99 • SC-300 / AZ-500 / SC-200: USD \$165 • Annual free renewal via Microsoft Learn assessment
Validity / Renewal	1 year • Free renewal annually via online assessment at Microsoft Learn
CIDPro Book Connection	Entire book. SC-300 specifically maps to: Ch 3 (Auth), Ch 4 (Authz), Ch 9 (ZT), Ch 10 (MFA), Ch 13 (IGA/Governance), Ch 19 (PAM/PIM), Ch 20 (Monitoring/Sentinel)
Notes	SC-300 is the #1 recommended starting certification for Microsoft-ecosystem IAM careers globally. Covers Entra ID lifecycle, Conditional Access, PIM, B2B/B2C collaboration, Identity Governance, and monitoring. Free preparation resources on Microsoft Learn are comprehensive. Annual free renewal keeps the credential current with platform updates. Microsoft holds the largest enterprise identity deployment share globally.

Official URL: <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/credentials/certifications/>

Ping Identity (inc. ForgeRock) | ♦ Workforce IAM

Focus: Federated identity (PingFederate), MFA (PingID), access management (PingAccess), and CIAM/ForgeRock AM/IDM

Field	Details
Certification(s)	Certified PingFederate Professional • Certified PingID Specialist • Certified PingAccess Administrator • ForgeRock Certified Access Management Specialist • ForgeRock Certified Identity Management Specialist
Level	Practitioner → Specialist
Format	Online exam / instructor-led training badges (Standalone Pearson VUE ForgeRock exams discontinued May 2025)
Approximate Cost	See training.pingidentity.com for current pricing and delivery options
Validity / Renewal	2–3 years
CIDPro Book Connection	Ch 5 (Federation), Ch 3 (Authentication), Ch 14 (CIAM — ForgeRock path)

Field	Details
Notes	⚠ IMPORTANT: Ping Identity and ForgeRock merged and standalone Pearson VUE exam booking was discontinued May 14, 2025. Certifications now delivered through the unified Ping Identity training portal. ForgeRock certifications remain in-market and are recognised — particularly in APAC financial services and government organisations. Verify current availability at training.pingidentity.com before planning your study programme.

Official URL: <https://training.pingidentity.com/>

IBM Security Verify | ♦ Workforce IAM

Focus: IBM Security Verify — cloud IAM, workforce SSO, CIAM, and directory integration

Field	Details
Certification(s)	IBM Certified Solution Advisor — Identity • IBM Certified Solution Expert — Security Verify
Level	Advisor (knowledge-level) → Expert (implementation level)
Format	Online exam via Pearson VUE
Approximate Cost	USD ~\$200 per exam
Validity / Renewal	2 years
CIDPro Book Connection	Ch 3 (Authentication), Ch 5 (Federation), Ch 14 (CIAM)
Notes	IBM Security Verify is the combined cloud IAM platform (formerly IBM ISAM and Cloud Identity). Certification particularly relevant for organisations using IBM infrastructure in banking, insurance, and government — common in Asia-Pacific public sector.

Official URL: <https://www.ibm.com/training/certifications/>

E. Cloud Platform Identity Certifications

Cloud platforms have their own IAM models — IAM policies, service accounts, workload identity, and cloud-native access controls that differ from on-premises directory-based models.

Amazon Web Services (AWS) | ♦ Cloud

Focus: Cloud IAM — IAM policies, SCP, STS, Cognito, AWS SSO (IAM Identity Center), Secrets Manager

Field	Details
Certification(s)	AWS Certified Security – Specialty (strongest IAM coverage) • AWS Certified Solutions Architect Associate/Professional (includes IAM) • AWS Cloud Practitioner (Foundation — IAM concepts)
Level	Foundation → Associate → Specialty
Format	Proctored online or in-person (Pearson VUE) • 65 questions • 170 minutes (Specialty)
Approximate Cost	Foundation: USD \$100 • Associate: USD \$150 • Specialty: USD \$300
Validity / Renewal	3 years • Recertify by passing the same or higher exam

Field	Details
CIDPro Book Connection	Ch 4 (Authorisation — IAM Policies), Ch 8 (Cloud Identity), Ch 9 (Zero Trust in Cloud), Ch 12 (NHI — Secrets Manager)
Notes	AWS Certified Security – Specialty is the highest-value AWS credential for IAM professionals, covering IAM Policies, SCPs, Cognito, Secrets Manager, and KMS in depth. No standalone IAM-only certification exists; IAM knowledge is tested across all AWS security certifications. AWS has the largest global cloud market share.

Official URL: <https://aws.amazon.com/certification/>

Google Cloud | ♦ Cloud

Focus: GCP IAM — Organisation Policies, IAM Conditions, Identity-Aware Proxy, Workload Identity Federation

Field	Details
Certification(s)	Professional Cloud Security Engineer (deep GCP IAM coverage) • Associate Cloud Engineer (Foundation — IAM basics)
Level	Associate → Professional
Format	Proctored online (Kryterion Webassessor) • 50–60 questions • 120 minutes
Approximate Cost	Associate: USD \$200 • Professional: USD \$200
Validity / Renewal	2 years • Recertification required
CIDPro Book Connection	Ch 4 (Authorisation), Ch 8 (Cloud Identity), Ch 12 (NHI — Workload Identity)
Notes	The Professional Cloud Security Engineer certification is the most IAM-relevant GCP credential, covering organisation policies, IAM conditions, VPC Service Controls, IAP, and Workload Identity Federation for service accounts and external workloads.

Official URL: <https://cloud.google.com/learn/certification/cloud-security-engineer>

F. Broad Cybersecurity Certifications with Strong IAM Content

These broad cybersecurity certifications include significant IAM content and are widely held by senior IAM professionals alongside dedicated IAM credentials.

(ISC)² — CISSP | ♦ Security

Focus: Information security — Domain 5 (Identity and Access Management) out of 8 domains

Field	Details
Certification(s)	Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
Level	Expert (5 years paid security experience required)
Format	Computer Adaptive Testing (CAT) • 125–175 questions • 4 hours • Pearson VUE
Approximate Cost	USD \$749
Validity / Renewal	3 years • 120 CPE credits (40/year)

Field	Details
CIDPro Book Connection	All chapters contribute. Most relevant: Ch 3 (Auth), Ch 4 (Authz), Ch 9 (ZT), Ch 10 (MFA), Ch 15–16 (Compliance)
Notes	The gold-standard broad security credential. CISSP Domain 5 maps closely to the CIDPro curriculum. Many senior IAM professionals hold both CISSP and a dedicated IAM credential (CIDPro, CIAM). CISSP Associate pathway available for candidates without 5 years of experience.

Official URL: <https://www.isc2.org/certifications/cissp>

(ISC)² — CCSP | ♦ Security

Focus: Cloud security — cloud IAM, identity federation, and cloud access management

Field	Details
Certification(s)	Certified Cloud Security Professional (CCSP)
Level	Expert (5 years IT, 3 years security, 1 year cloud required)
Format	Online proctored · 150 questions · 4 hours
Approximate Cost	USD \$599
Validity / Renewal	3 years · 90 CPE credits
CIDPro Book Connection	Ch 8 (Cloud Identity), Ch 4 (Authorisation), Ch 9 (Zero Trust Cloud)
Notes	Valuable for IAM architects working in multi-cloud environments. Cloud IAM is a significant component across CCSP domains 1, 2, and 5. Often paired with CIDPro or CISSP for cloud IAM leadership roles.

Official URL: <https://www.isc2.org/certifications/ccsp>

ISACA — CISM | ♦ Security

Focus: Security management — governance, risk, programme development, and incident management

Field	Details
Certification(s)	Certified Information Security Manager (CISM)
Level	Management / Senior Practitioner (5 years IS experience, 3 years security management)
Format	Online or in-person (Pearson VUE) · 150 questions · 4 hours
Approximate Cost	USD \$575 (ISACA members) / \$760 (non-members)
Validity / Renewal	3 years · 120 CPE credits
CIDPro Book Connection	Ch 15–16 (Compliance), Ch 22 (Identity at Scale), Ch 20 (Monitoring & Response)
Notes	Widely held by IAM managers and security directors. Covers information risk management and security governance that underpins all IAM programme design. Often paired with CIDPro or CIAM for IAM leadership career paths.

Official URL: <https://www.isaca.org/credentialing/cism>

ISACA — CISA | ♦ *Security**Focus: IS audit, control, and assurance — includes access control audit and IAM compliance*

Field	Details
Certification(s)	Certified Information Systems Auditor (CISA)
Level	Practitioner (5 years IS audit/control experience)
Format	Online or in-person · 150 questions · 4 hours
Approximate Cost	USD \$575 (members) / \$760 (non-members)
Validity / Renewal	3 years · 120 CPE credits
CIDPro Book Connection	Ch 15–16 (Compliance), Ch 13 (IGA — access reviews), Ch 19 (PAM — audit trails)
Notes	The premier credential for IAM governance and compliance auditors. Compliance teams, internal auditors, and IAM governance professionals in financial services and healthcare frequently hold CISA alongside a technical IAM credential.

Official URL: <https://www.isaca.org/credentialing/cisa>

Quick Reference — All Certifications

Certification	Issuer	Category	Level	Cost (approx)	URL
CIDPro™	IDPro	Vendor-Neutral IAM	Professional	\$400–550	idpro.org/cidpro/
CIAM®	IMI	Vendor-Neutral IAM	Expert	\$295–395	identitymanagementinstitute.org/ciam
CAMS®	IMI	Access Management	Practitioner	\$195–295	identitymanagementinstitute.org
CIGE®	IMI	Governance Expert	Expert	\$395	identitymanagementinstitute.org
CIMP®	IMI	IAM Implementation	Technical	\$195–295	identitymanagementinstitute.org
CIST® / CIPA® / CDP®	IMI	Security Tech / Protection	Practitioner+	\$195–395	identitymanagementinstitute.org
NHI Foundation	NHIMG	Non-Human Identity	Foundation	See website	nhimg.org/nhi-training
SailPoint (IIQ/IDNow)	SailPoint	IGA	Associate–Architect	\$150–500	community.sailpoint.com/certifications
Saviynt ISAA (FREE)	Saviynt	IGA / AI Identity	Foundation	FREE	saviynt.com/university
CyberArk Trustee–Guardian	CyberArk	PAM	Foundation–Expert	~\$200/exam	cyberark.com/certification
BeyondTrust Admin	BeyondTrust	PAM	Practitioner	See website	beyondtrust.com/education
Delinea PAM Prof.	Delinea	PAM	Practitioner	See website	delinea.com/certification
Okta Pro/Admin/Consultant	Okta	Workforce IAM + CIAM	Foundation–Expert	\$250–\$5,000	okta.com/certification
SC-900	Microsoft	Security Fundamentals	Fundamentals	\$99	learn.microsoft.com/certifications
SC-300	Microsoft	Entra ID Administration	Associate	\$165	learn.microsoft.com/certifications
AZ-500	Microsoft	Azure Security (+ IAM)	Associate	\$165	learn.microsoft.com/certifications
Ping/ForgeRock	Ping Identity	Federation / SSO / CIAM	Practitioner	See website	training.pingidentity.com
IBM Security Verify	IBM	Workforce / CIAM	Advisor–Expert	~\$200	ibm.com/training/certifications
AWS Security Specialty	AWS	Cloud IAM	Specialty	\$300	aws.amazon.com/certification
GCP Security	Google	Cloud IAM	Professional	\$200	cloud.google.com/

Certification	Issuer	Category	Level	Cost (approx)	URL
Engineer			al		certification
CISSP	(ISC) ²	Broad Security	Expert	\$749	isc2.org/certifications/cissp
CCSP	(ISC) ²	Cloud Security	Expert	\$599	isc2.org/certifications/ccsp
CISM	ISACA	Security Management	Senior	\$575–760	isaca.org/credentialing/cism
CISA	ISACA	IS Audit	Practitioner	\$575–760	isaca.org/credentialing/cisa

Accuracy Note

Certification costs, formats, and URLs are accurate as of May 2026. Certification programmes change regularly — always verify current details on the official URL before registering. Where exam formats have changed significantly (CyberArk in-person only; Ping Identity/ForgeRock exam changes), specific notices appear in the relevant certification card above.